General Terminal UI Layout

```
+-------------------------------------------------------------+
| Header: Game Title / Location / Player Status               |
+-------------------------------------------------------------+
|                                                             |
|                                                             |
|                ASCII Art / Visual Area                      |
|                                                             |
|                                                             |
+-------------------------------------------------------------+
| Main Content Area                                           |
| - Story text                                                |
| - Combat log                                                |
| - Inventory list                                            |
| - Shop dialogue                                             |
|                                                             |
+-------------------------------------------------------------+
| Options Menu                                                |
| [A] Action 1    [B] Action 2    [C] Action 3                |
+-------------------------------------------------------------+
| Input Prompt: Enter your choice                             |
+-------------------------------------------------------------+
```

- All game screens use this terminal-based layout
- The header displays context-specific information
- The ASCII art section changes depending on screen
- The main content area displays story, combat, or inventory
- The options menu and input prompt handle user interaction

Title Screen

```
⚔  TERMINAL RPG ADVENTURE  ⚔

 ______________
|              |
|   [ASCII ART |
|    HERO/LOGO]|
|______________|


[A] New Game
[B] Tutorial
[C] Credits
[Q] Quit
```

Components:

- Title banner with game name
- ASCII art placeholder for game logo/background
- Main menu with four options

User Inputs:

- [A] - Start a new game
- [B] - Open tutorial/help screen
- [C] - View credits
- [Q] - Quit the application

Purpose:
Main entry point for the game. Provides navigation to all major starting sections and sets the visual tone for the game.

Navigation:
[A] → Class Selection Screen
[B] → Tutorial Screen
[C] → Credits Screen
[Q] → Exit application

Class Selection Screen

```
CHOOSE YOUR HERO

[A] 🤠 COWBOY          [B] 🧪 SCIENTIST        [C] 🏹 ARCHER

 ASCII                  ASCII                   ASCII
 COWBOY                 SCIENTIST               ARCHER
  ART                    ART                     ART

HP:  ▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓ 80     HP:  ▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓ 60      HP:  ▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓ 70
ATK: ▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓ 80     ATK: ▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓ 40      ATK: ▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓ 60
SPD: ▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓ 40     SPD: ▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓ 80      SPD: ▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓ 70

"Quick draw and        "Master of strange      "Precision and
 high damage"           potions & science"      range attacks"

Ability: Quick Shot    Ability: Toxic Vial     Ability: Piercing Shot

Select your class [A/B/C] or [Q] to quit
```

Components:

- Header with selection prompt
- Three character class cards displayed side-by-side
- ASCII art representation for each class
- Stat bars showing HP, ATK, and SPD for comparison
- Class description text

User Inputs:

- [A] - Select Cowboy class (high attack, moderate health)
- [B] - Select Scientist class (ability-focused, special effects)
- [C] - Select Archer class (balanced stats, precision attacks)
- [Q] - Return to Title Screen

Purpose:
Allow players to choose their character class.

Navigation:
[A/B/C] → Main Story/Exploration Screen (game begins)
[Q] → Title Screen

Main Story/Exploration Screen

```
LOCATION: Desert Wasteland                 Cowboy | LVL 3 | HP: 85/100

                        [LOCATION ASCII ART]

STORY:

You venture deeper into the Desert Wasteland. The scorching sun beats
down as the path ahead splits into three directions. Heat waves shimmer
in the distance...

Suddenly, you notice something glimmering half-buried in the sand.

CHOICES:

 [A] Take the left path toward the distant rock formations
 [B] Take the right path where you see vultures circling
 [C] Investigate the glimmering object
 [D] Turn back to the village

 [I] Inventory  |  [S] Status  |  [Q] Quit Game
```

Components:

- Header showing current location and player status (class, level, HP)
- ASCII art depicting the current environment
- Story text section with narrative description
- Multiple choice menu for story decisions (A/B/C/D)
- Quick access menu for inventory, status, and quit options

User Inputs:

- [A/B/C/D] - Make story choices that affect narrative progression
- [I] - Open inventory screen (accessible anytime)
- [S] - View character status screen (accessible anytime)
- [Q] - Quit to main menu

Purpose:
Players make decisions that affect their journey, trigger events, combat encounters, and item discoveries.

Navigation:
[A/B/C/D] → New story segment, combat encounter, item discovery, or shop
[I] → Inventory Screen
[S] → Character Status Screen
[Q] → Title Screen

Combat Screen - Enemy Encounter

```
⚔️  BATTLE  ⚔️

WASTELAND RAIDER                          🤠 COWBOY (LVL 3)
LVL 2

     ___                                        O
    /o o\                                      /|\
   ( --- )                                     / \
    \___/                                      🔫
     | |

HP: ▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓ 45/45                    HP: ▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓ 85/100
STATUS: Normal                            EXP: ▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓ 125/200

COMBAT LOG:
> A wild Wasteland Raider appears!
> The Raider brandishes a rusty blade and charges!

YOUR TURN - Choose an action:

[A] ⚔️  Attack          - Basic attack (damage: 15-20)
[B] ✨ Quick Shot       - Special ability (damage: 25-30)
[C] 🎒 Use Item         - Open inventory
[D] 🏃 Run Away         - Attempt to flee (50% chance)
```

Components:

- Enemy display (left side) - name, level, ASCII art, HP bar, status
- Player display (right side) - class emoji, name, level, ASCII art, HP bar, EXP bar
- Combat log showing recent battle actions and dialogue
- Action menu with four combat options and damage ranges

User Inputs:

- [A] - Execute basic attack (deals 15-20 damage)
- [B] - Use class special ability (deals 25-30 damage, class-specific)
- [C] - Open inventory to use healing/buff items
- [D] - Attempt to flee combat

Purpose:
Players battle enemies. Provides strategic decision-making, real-time feedback on actions.

Navigation:
Combat continues until enemy defeated or player flees/dies
Victory → Experience gain → Exploration Screen or Level Up Screen
Defeat → Game Over Screen (Player Death)
[C] → Inventory Screen (remains in combat context)

Inventory Screen

```
🎒 INVENTORY
🤠 Cowboy | LVL 3 | HP: 85/100                    Gold: 150💰

CONSUMABLES:                          EQUIPMENT:
────────────                          ──────────
[1] 🧪 Health Potion (x3)             [E] 🔫 Rusty Revolver
    Restores 50 HP                        ATK +5

[2] 💪 Strength Tonic (x1)            [F] 🎯 Leather Vest
    +10 ATK for 3 turns                   DEF +3

[3] 🛡️ Defense Boost (x2)
    +10 DEF for 3 turns

KEY ITEMS:
──────────
[K] 🔑 Rusty Key
    An old key found in the wasteland

Select item [1-9] to view details | [U] Use | [E] Equip | [B] Back
```

Components:

- Player status bar (class, level, HP, gold)
- Consumables, Equipment, Key Items
- Item entries showing: icon, name, quantity, description, effects
- Footer with action instructions

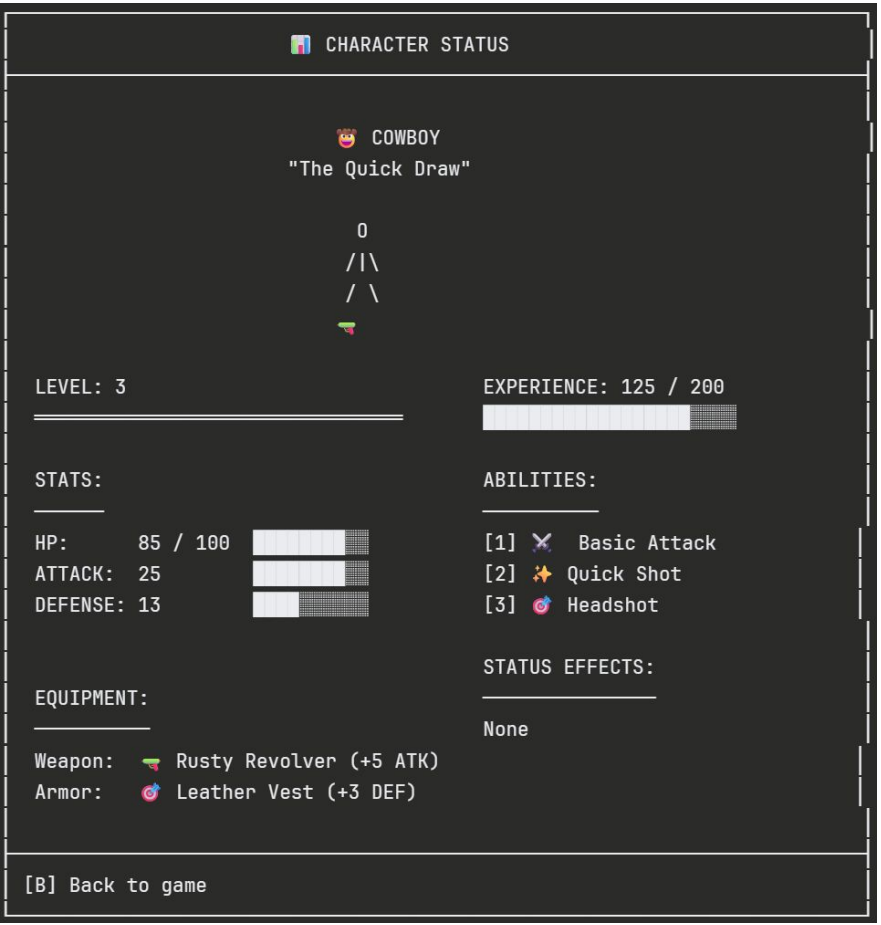
User Inputs:

- [1-9] - Select numbered item to view details
- [U] - Use selected consumable item
- [E] - Equip/unequip selected equipment
- [B] - Return to previous screen

Purpose:
Manage player's collected items, equipment, and consumables.

Navigation:
[B] → Returns to previous screen
Items used → Updates player stats
Equipment changed → Updates stats

Character Status Screen



Components:

- Character information: class name, class title, ASCII art
- Level display and experience progress bar
- Stats section with visual bars (HP, Attack, Defense)
- Abilities list showing available combat skills
- Footer with back navigation

User Inputs:

- [B] - Return to previous screen

Purpose:
Display comprehensive character information including stats, progression, equipment, and abilities.

Navigation:
[B] → Returns to previous screen

Level Up Screen

```
⭐ LEVEL UP! ⭐

You reached Level 4!

STAT INCREASES:
──────────────
HP:      +15  (100 → 115)
ATTACK:  +3   (25 → 28)
DEFENSE: +2   (13 → 15)

🎉 You feel stronger! 🎉

Press [ENTER] to continue
```

Components:

- New level number announcement
- Motivational message
- Stat increases

User Inputs:

- [ENTER] - Continue to next screen

Purpose:
Celebrate player progression and clearly display stat improvements gained from leveling up.

Navigation:
[ENTER] → Returns to Exploration Screen

Shop/Merchant Screen

```
🏪 WANDERING MERCHANT
Your Gold: 150💰

"Greetings, traveler! Care to see my wares?"

🧙
/|\
/ \
🛒

ITEMS FOR SALE:

[1] 🧪 Health Potion ....................... 30💰
    Restores 50 HP

[2] 💪 Strength Tonic ...................... 40💰
    +10 ATK for 3 turns

[3] 🔫 Steel Revolver ...................... 200💰
    ATK +12 (Upgrade from Rusty Revolver)

[4] 🛡️ Iron Vest ........................... 180💰
    DEF +8 (Upgrade from Leather Vest)

[5] 🗡️ Lucky Charm ......................... 500💰
    +10% critical hit chance

[1-5] Buy item | [S] Sell items | [B] Back to exploration
```

Components:

- Merchant dialogue/greeting text
- Merchant ASCII art representation
- Items for sale list
- Footer with purchase, sell, and exit options

User Inputs:

- [1-5] - Purchase corresponding item
- [S] - Enter sell mode to sell items from inventory
- [B] - Exit shop and return to exploration

Purpose:
Allow players to spend earned gold on items, equipment upgrades, and consumables.

Navigation:
[1-5] → Purchase item → Gold deducted → Item added to inventory
[S] → Opens inventory in sell mode → Select items to sell

Boss Battle Screen

```
⚔️  FINAL BOSS BATTLE  ⚔️

👹 ??? (LVL 10)                          🤠 COWBOY (LVL 8)

      /\___/\                                    O
     ( o   o )                                  /|\
     (  =^=  )                                  / \
    __|  ~  |__                                 🔫
   /  \_____/  \
  |  /       \  |

HP: ▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓ 450/500                   HP: ▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓ 180/200
PHASE: 2/3                               EXP: ▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓ 580/600
STATUS: Enraged                          STATUS: Determined

COMBAT LOG:
> The mysterious figure emerges from the shadows!
> "So... you've made it this far, mortal..."
> ??? used Dark Pulse! (-35 HP)

⚠️  CRITICAL MOMENT - Choose wisely:

[A] ⚔️  Desperate Strike    - High risk, high reward (40-60 damage)
[B] ✨ Ultimate Quick Shot  - Powerful attack (50-70 damage)
[C] 🧪 Last Health Potion   - Restore 50 HP, lose turn
[D] 🛡️ Defensive Stance     - Reduce next damage by 50%
```

Components:

- Boss display (left) - name, level, enhanced ASCII art, HP bar, phase indicator, status

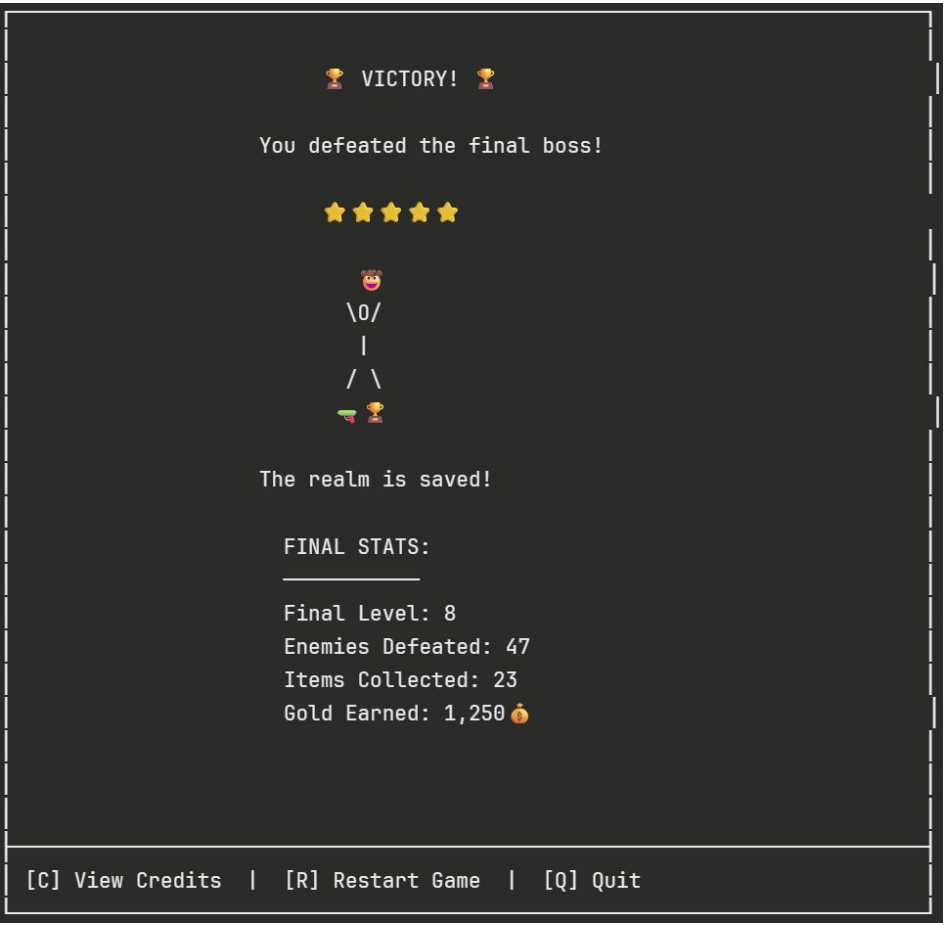
User Inputs:

- [A] - High-risk attack
- [B] - Ultimate special ability
- [C] - Use healing item
- [D] - Defensive maneuver

Purpose:
Multi-phase boss fight that tests player's strategic skills and resource management.

Navigation:
Boss defeated → Victory Screen
Player defeated → Game Over Screen (Player Death)
Combat continues through multiple phases until conclusion

Victory/Game Over Screen



Components:

- Victory message
- Victorious character ASCII art in celebration pose
- Final statistics summary
- Post-game options menu

User Inputs:

- [C] - View credits screen
- [R] - Restart game
- [Q] - Quit

Purpose:
Celebrate player's successful completion of the game.

Navigation:
[C] → Credits Screen
[R] → Class Selection Screen (new game)
[Q] → Exit application

Player Death/Game Over Screen

```
💀 GAME OVER 💀

You have been defeated...

      ☠
     ---
    /   \
   | X X |
   |  ~  |
    \___/
      |
     /|\
    / | \

Your journey ends here...

FINAL STATS:
────────────
Final Level: 3
Enemies Defeated: 12
Items Collected: 8
Gold Earned: 340💰

[R] Try Again  |  [M] Main Menu  |  [Q] Quit Game
```

Components:

- Defeat message
- Defeated character ASCII art
- Final statistics summary
- Retry/menu options

User Inputs:

- [R] - Retry from beginning
- [M] - Return to main menu/title screen
- [Q] - Quit application

Purpose:
Handle player defeat scenario. Provides closure while offering options to try again or return to menu.

Navigation:
[R] → Class Selection Screen or last checkpoint
[M] → Title Screen
[Q] → Exit application

Tutorial Screen

```
📖 TUTORIAL

BASIC CONTROLS

Throughout the game, you'll make choices using letter keys:

• Press [A], [B], [C], etc. to select story choices
• Press [I] to open your inventory at any time
• Press [S] to view your character status
• Press [Q] to quit to main menu
• Press [ENTER] to confirm selections

COMBAT BASICS

When you encounter enemies, you'll enter turn-based combat:

• Choose to Attack, use Abilities, use Items, or Run
• Each action takes one turn
• Defeating enemies gives you EXP and rewards
• Running away is always an option (but not guaranteed!)

LEVELING UP

• Gain experience by defeating enemies
• Level up to increase your HP, Attack, and Defense
• Higher levels unlock stronger abilities

[B] Back to Main Menu  |  [ENTER] Start Game
```

Components:

- Tutorial Header
- Basic Controls (keyboard input guide)
- Combat Basics
- Leveling Up
- Footer with navigation options

User Inputs:

- [B] - Return to Title Screen
- [ENTER] - Start game directly

Purpose:
Teach new players the core mechanics and controls before starting the game. Provides clear, concise instructions on gameplay systems.

Navigation:
[B] → Title Screen
[ENTER] → Class Selection Screen (begin game)

Credits Screen

```
⚔  TERMINAL RPG  ⚔

DEVELOPMENT TEAM
────────────────

Lead Developer
[Name Here]

Game Design
[Name Here]
[Name Here]

Programming
[Name Here]
[Name Here]

ASCII Art & UI
[Name Here]

Story & Dialogue
[Name Here]

Thank you for playing!

[B] Back to Main Menu
```

Components:

- Game title header
- Development team section with roles
- Team member name
- Thank you message
- Return navigation

User Inputs:

- [B] - Return to Title Screen

Purpose:
Acknowledge the development team and their contributions. Give credit to all contributors. Thank players for playing the game.

Navigation:
[B] → Title Screen